
**DEPARTMENT
POLICY****All Programs**

According to federal and state law, the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services (MDHHS) is a designated voter registration agency. Laws require that MDHHS provide voter registration services to MDHHS clients in specific situations. These services include:

- Providing form NSP-938-B, Michigan Voter Registration Application, at specified times and upon request.
- Providing form ED-121a, Michigan Voter Preregistration Application and Change Address Form upon request.
- Assisting clients in completing the NSP-938-B.
- Assisting client in completing the ED-121a
- Accepting and validating the NSP-938-B.
- Accepting and validating the ED-121a.
- Forwarding the NSP-938-B to the appropriate governmental clerk in a timely manner.
- Forwarding the ED-121a to the appropriate governmental clerk in a timely manner.

**IN PERSON
TRANSACTIONS**

Individuals are required to present photo identification when registering to vote in person. If an individual does not possess photo identification, he/she is permitted to sign an affidavit form to this effect.

Acceptable photo identification documents include:

- Michigan driver's license or Michigan personal identification card (current or expired).
- Current driver's license or personal identification card issued by another state.
- Current federal or state government-issued photo identification.

- Current U.S. passport.
- Current student identification with photo – from a high school or an accredited institution of higher education.
- Current military identification card with photo.
- Current tribal identification card with photo.

Voter registration applicants that do not possess one of the above-listed photo ID documents may sign the DHS-1185, Affidavit of Voter not in Possession of Picture Identification Form.

The DHS-1185 should be stapled to the voter registration form (NSP-938-B and/or ED-121a) and sent to the governmental clerk.

OBTAINING FORMS

- The NSP-938-B may be obtained from the:
 - Department of Technology, Management and Budget (DTMB) warehouse.
 - Online at the website: [Doing Business With MDHHS/Forms & Applications](#). Select the NSP-938-B from the Applications category.
- The ED-121a may be obtained online: [ED-121: Michigan Voter Registration Application and Change of Address Form](#).

The Bureau of Elections prohibits MDHHS from making the NSP-938-B and/or the ED-121a form available on MS Word. Photo copies may be used if supplies run short. Individual copies may also be printed from the MDHHS public website.

The MDHHS-1185 is available in the MDHHS Forms Library.

ISSUING VOTER REGISTRATION FORMS

Distribute an NSP-938-B:

- With an application for assistance, including, but not limited to:
 - MDHHS-1171, Assistance Application.

- DHS-4575, Medicaid Application (Patient of Nursing Facility).
- DHS-4574-B, Assets Declaration.
- DHS-1011, Medicaid Supplemental Application.
- With a redetermination, including, but not limited to:
 - MDHHS-1010, Redetermination Form.
 - DHS-542, MiCAP Redetermination Form.
- Upon request.
- When a change of physical address is reported to the local office.

Exception: The only time an NSP-938-B is not distributed is when an individual declines in writing by checking the *No* box on page seven of the MDHHS-1171, Assistance Application, or declines in writing on another MDHHS form that asks whether the individual would like to register to vote. **If this question is unanswered (left blank), distribute an NSP-938-B.**

Note: An NSP-938-B is automatically generated and mailed when *Yes-out of office transaction* is selected, and when an individual reports a change of physical address.

- When an individual applies for assistance, redetermination or reports a change of physical address in the local office, distribute an NSP-938-B in person.

If for any reason, an NSP-938-B is not distributed while the individual is in the local office, and the individual has not declined to register to vote, select *Yes-out of office transaction*, so an NSP-938-B is automatically mailed.

For forms that do not include the voter registration question, mail an NSP-938-B to the individual.

Note: Individuals using MI Bridges to apply for or renew benefits are automatically offered an NSP-938-B and the response is pre filled in Bridges.

Note: The ED-121a only needs to be distributed upon request.

ASSISTING INDIVIDUALS

Assist individuals in the completion of the NSP-938-B and/or ED-121a when requested. **Do not:**

- Seek to influence an individual's political preference or party.
- Display any political preference or party allegiance.
- Make any statement or take any action to discourage a person from registering to vote.
- Make any statement or take any action which may lead a person to believe that a decision to register to vote or not to register to vote has any bearing on their eligibility for services or benefits.

PROCEDURE

Complete Form Returned

When a complete NSP 938-B and/ or ED-121a is received complete the following steps:

- Accept the completed form.
- Review the form to ensure that it is complete and legible.
- When the yes box is checked, the upper-most portion of the form serves as the individual's voter registration receipt.
- Detach and give or mail the receipt to the individual once the form is validated.
- Forward the lower portion of the completed NSP-938-B to the local office voter registration services coordinator **immediately** upon receipt, to ensure that forms will be sent to the appropriate governmental clerk in a timely manner; see Timely Forwarding Voter Registration Forms in this item.
- Forward the top of portion of the completed ED-121a to the local office voter voter registration services coordinator immediately upon receipt, to ensure that forms will be sent to the appropriate governmental clerk in a timely manner

Incomplete NSP-938-B

If an individual returns an NSP-938-B with the Yes box checked but it is missing a signature or information forward to the local office voter registration services coordinator *immediately*.

Note: Bureau of Elections has a process in place to follow up with a client for missing information.

If an individual returns an NSP-938-B with the No box checked, completion of the remainder of the form is not necessary. Enter the current date and your initials in the upper right corner of the form, and forward to the local office voter registration services coordinator for storage; see Storing Declinations below.

Incomplete ED-121a

If an individual returns an incomplete ED-121a forward to the local office voter registration services coordinator immediately.

**VOTER
REGISTRATION
SERVICES
COORDINATOR
RESPONSIBILITIES**

Each local office must designate a voter registration services coordinator as well as a back-up coordinator. Coordinator responsibilities include all of the following:

- Answering local office questions regarding voter registration services.
- Ensuring that there is an adequate supply of voter registration applications in both English and Spanish.
- Ensuring that there are voter registration applications available in the local/district office lobby.
- If it is determined or a report is received that an individual was not given the appropriate opportunity to register to vote, ensure

that an NSP-938-B, along with an explanatory letter, is mailed to the individual. A template for the explanatory letter can be obtained by contacting the central office voter registration coordinator, see Communicating with Central Office Voter Registration Services Coordinator in this item.

Note: A copy of the letter sent to the individual must be retained in the local office for 24 months.

- Prominently displaying National Voter Registration Act (NVRA) posters in each local/district office lobby and ensuring that posters are available for community partners, as requested.
- Reporting voter registration information; see Reporting and Tracking in this item.
- Forwarding complete and incomplete voter registration forms to the governmental clerk of the county, city or township in a timely manner; see Timely Forwarding of Voter Registration Forms in this item.
- Communicating with the central office voter registration services coordinator; see Communicating With Central Office Voter Registration Services Coordinator in this item.

Timely Forwarding of Voter Registration Forms

Voter registration services coordinators must forward voter registration forms ***within seven calendar days*** of receipt in the local office. Forms must be forwarded to the governmental clerk of the county, city or township where the client resides.

Exception: During the 7 day period which precedes the registration deadline forms must be forwarded to the governmental clerk of the county, city or township ***within one business day***. This is required to allow a person who registers close to the close of registration to participate in the election.

Where to Send Voter Registration Forms

Forward the complete NSP-938-B and/ or Ed-121a to the governmental clerk of the county, city or township where the client

resides. The governmental clerk information can be found at the website: Michigan.gov/Vote.

If it is unclear where to send the form, forward to:

Department of State
Bureau of Elections
P.O. Box 20126
Lansing, Michigan, 48901-0726

Storing Declinations

An NSP-938-B with the *No* box checked is known as a declination. This individual has declined the opportunity to register or update their voter's registration. Declinations must be retained in a designated location in the local office for 24 months.

Communicating with Central Office Voter Registration Services Coordinator

Local office voter registration services coordinators communicate with the central office voter registration services coordinator via email at: MDHHSVotes@michigan.gov.

Questions regarding this policy may be addressed through this avenue.

Local office voter registration services coordinators must contact the central office voter registration services coordinator for the following:

- Gain access to the NVRA summary reporting tool through the [MDHHS MiLogin - Home Page \(michigan.gov\)](https://Michigan.gov/MiLogin).
- Request the template for the explanatory letter.
- Provide the name, phone number and email address of the local office voter registration services coordinator and back-up coordinator and the county and/or district they represent.
- When there is a change in the local office voter registration services coordinator or back-up coordinator, the following information must be submitted:

- Name.
- Phone and fax numbers.
- County office.
- District office, if applicable.

REPORTING AND TRACKING

Each local office voter registration services coordinator must complete the NVRA Activity Reporting System available on the MDHHS [MiLogin - Home Page \(michigan.gov\)](https://michigan.gov/milogin) The summary report is due by the fifth of each month (or next business day if the fifth falls on a non-work day). Instructions and access to this tool are available from the central office coordinator.

The summary report requires coordinators to report the number of completed voter registration forms received by the local/district office. Keep track of the number of completed registration forms forwarded to the governmental clerks each week and enter the monthly total on the report.

LEGAL BASE

All Programs

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